American Century Investments®

Equity Income Fund

Quarterly Commentary

Portfolio Review

U.S. stocks advanced despite a challenging backdrop. Strong corporate earnings and continued investment in artificial intelligence supported equity markets, but the ongoing conflict in Iran pushed oil prices higher, fueling inflation concerns and weakening consumer confidence, while higher bond rates of return and a Federal Reserve interest rate hike helped drive expectations that interest rates could remain elevated.

Large-cap and value stocks broadly outperformed. Large-cap stocks led the market's gains, while mid- and small-cap equities declined. Value stocks outpaced their growth counterparts across the market-capitalization spectrum.

Industrials drove underperformance. Stock selection weighed on returns compared with the benchmark, along with an overweight relative to the benchmark to the building products industry, where Owens Corning was among the period's largest overall detractors. Stock choices and an underweight in the professional services industry also detracted, driven largely by information services company Equifax. Elsewhere, our position in industrial conglomerate Dover hindered relative results.

Information technology hurt. Underweight exposure to the sector relative to the benchmark weighed on returns, with our underweight to Apple, which was among the largest overall detractors regardless of sector, as the key driver. A lack of exposure to enterprise software company Salesforce and other benchmark software stocks also hindered relative performance.

Financials helped. Stock selection, especially in the insurance industry, contributed to returns compared with the benchmark, led by positions in life reinsurer Reinsurance Group of America and insurance brokerage and risk management firm Marsh & McLennan Cos. A lack of exposure to several benchmark constituents in the consumer finance and capital markets industries, including financial services firm Goldman Sachs Group, also added value.

Key Contributors

Becton Dickinson and Co. The medical technology company reported strong quarterly results, improved cash flow and a higher earnings outlook amid ongoing operating improvements, portfolio simplification and productivity initiatives.

Intel. Not owning the chipmaker helped. Shares declined sharply in July and parts of August amid concerns around rising capital spending and uncertainty surrounding Intel's turnaround and contract manufacturing strategy, despite robust quarterly results.

Medtronic. The medical technology company outperformed as better-than-expected earnings and an upwardly revised full-year outlook showed robust demand for cardiovascular devices and other key categories, which combined strength in new products and a promising pipeline to highlight the company's growth opportunities.

Key Detractors

Apple. The portfolio's underweight position in Apple relative to the benchmark detracted as optimism around its ecosystem and artificial intelligence opportunities supported the stock during the period.

Goal and Strategy

Current income and long-term capital growth by investing in companies of all sizes that are believed to be undervalued.

Portfolio Management Team

	Start Date	
Name	Industry	Company
Brian Woglom, CFA	1998	2005
Paul Howanitz, CFA	2008	2015
Kevin Toney, CFA	1993	1999

Top 10 Holdings (%)

Microsoft Corp	5.17
Marsh & McLennan Cos Inc	2.97
Johnson & Johnson	2.96
Enterprise Products Partners LP	2.57
Becton Dickinson & Co	2.50
JPMorgan Chase & Co	2.39
Medtronic PLC	2.17
Kimberly-Clark Corp	2.16
Apple Inc	2.08
PepsiCo Inc	2.01

As of 9/30/2026

The holdings listed should not be considered recommendations to purchase or sell a particular security. Equity holdings are grouped to include common shares, depository receipts, rights and warrants issued by the same company. Fund holdings subject to change.

Owens Corning. The building products manufacturer forecast slightly lower third-quarter revenues as residential construction and remodeling remained under pressure, overshadowing the company's progress toward a more focused residential building products portfolio.

Kimberly-Clark. Shares of the household products maker declined after management lowered its growth outlook amid softer demand trends and disruptions in China. Strong margin execution partially offset concerns about slowing sales growth.

Notable Trades

Honeywell Aerospace. In our view, the aerospace and defense technology company's recent separation from Honeywell created an attractive entry point. We believe the company's strong positions in commercial aerospace and defense, supported by a sizable backlog, and aftermarket exposure will likely help drive future earnings growth.

Equifax. We believe the information services company's differentiated data assets, recurring customer relationships and exposure to a recovery in mortgage and employment activity offer an attractive combination of quality, growth and long-term earnings potential.

Citigroup. We exited the Citigroup preferred security after its expected return became less attractive relative to other income opportunities. The adjustment also helped manage portfolio concentration and created capacity for what we view as opportunities with stronger expected returns.

Target. We exited our position as persistent execution challenges and a cautious consumer backdrop reduced confidence in the retailer's near-term earnings recovery.

Portfolio Positioning

The portfolio seeks to invest in companies where we believe the valuation and relative rate of return do not reflect the quality and normal earnings power of the company. We believe this can result in a portfolio with higher rates of return and less volatility. Our process is based on individual security selection, but broad themes have emerged.

Higher-quality stocks may offer resilience. Uncertainty around the war in the Middle East, continuing inflation and uncertain macroeconomic and policy conditions, including tariffs, have contributed to a murky outlook for the economy and interest rates, leading investors to navigate an unsettled economic landscape. Against this backdrop, we continue to focus on companies we believe are of higher quality because of stable revenues and profits, low indebtedness, resilient cash flows and predictable business models that are less sensitive to economic conditions.

Opportunities in consumer staples and health care. We maintain an overweight in consumer staples relative to the benchmark. Even as consumers grapple with economic pressures like inflation, they still need to purchase the necessities offered by companies in the defensive consumer staples sector. We also remain keen on some health care stocks, particularly those in the health care equipment and supplies industry, because demand tends to be less susceptible to changes in the economic environment and, in our view, they are attractively valued.

Navigating the financials sector. We remain selective in the financials sector, the largest absolute weight in the portfolio. We have found some opportunities in banking, choosing companies that are well capitalized in operating environments that support improved profitability. We are overweight the insurance industry relative to the benchmark. Many insurers continue to benefit from favorable pricing, improving investment income and resilient demand for their products, a combination that we believe offers the potential to generate attractive returns across economic environments.

Few opportunities in consumer discretionary and real estate. While consumer activity has significantly supported the economy, recent economic reports point to a slowdown in spending. That may pressure consumer discretionary stocks, a sector where we already find it difficult to identify many companies with durable business models. Within the real estate sector, our analysis continues to show that most equities remain overvalued.

Information technology (IT) remains a sizable underweight. Following the sector's recent outperformance and the benchmark's midyear reconstitution, our underweight relative to the benchmark has grown since the end of the first quarter, even as we've added to our sector exposure. Many IT companies trade at valuations that we believe do not adequately compensate investors for the risks involved, and we've identified more compelling risk/return opportunities elsewhere.

Equity Income Fund

TICKERS Investor Class: TWEIX | I Class: ACIIX | A Class: TWEAX | C Class: AEYIX | R Class: AEURX | R5 Class: AEIUX | R6 Class: AEUDX

Data presented reflects past performance. Past performance is no guarantee of future results. Current performance may be higher or lower than the performance shown. To obtain performance data current to the most recent month end, please visit www.americancentury.com/performance. Investment return and share value will fluctuate, and redemption value may be more or less than original cost. Data assumes reinvestment of dividends and capital gains. Returns for periods less than one year are not annualized. For information about other share classes available, please consult the prospectus. There is no guarantee that the investment objectives will be met. Dividends and yields represent past performance and there is no guarantee that they will continue to be paid.

Average Annual Total Returns for Period Ended 9/30/2026

Class	Qtr (%)	1 Year (%)	3 Year (%)	5 Year (%)	10 Year (%)	Since Inception (%)	Inception Date	Gross Expense Ratio (%)
Investor	0.61	11.30	12.54	7.76	8.46	9.98	8/1/94	0.95
I	0.77	11.61	12.78	7.98	8.67	8.62	7/8/98	0.75
R5	0.66	11.52	12.76	7.97	8.66	8.21	4/10/17	0.75
R6	0.69	11.63	12.93	8.13	8.82	9.13	7/26/13	0.60
Russell 3000 Value Index	2.31	23.73	19.97	11.68	11.31	-	-	-

Historical performance for the R5 Class prior to its inception is based on the performance of I Class shares, which have the same expenses as the R5 Class.

Expense ratio is as of the fund's current prospectus. The I Class minimum investment amount is $5 million ($3 million for endowments and foundations) per fund. The R5 Share Class is available only to participants in group employer-sponsored retirement plans where a financial intermediary provides recordkeeping services to plan participants.

Periods greater than one year have been annualized.

You should consider the fund's investment objectives, risks, and charges and expenses carefully before you invest. The fund's prospectus or summary prospectus, which can be obtained at americancentury.com, contains this and other information about the fund, and should be read carefully before investing.

The fund invests in convertible securities, which may be affected by changes in interest rates, the credit of the issuer and the value of the underlying common stock. The fund also may invest in foreign securities, which can be riskier than investing in U.S. securities.

The opinions expressed are those of the portfolio investment team and are no guarantee of the future performance of any American Century Investments portfolio. Statements regarding specific holdings represent personal views and compensation has not been received in connection with such views. This information is for an educational purpose only and is not intended to serve as investment advice.

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